South Dakota - auto Insurance - Guidelines

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Purpose and authority

Internal Auto insurance operating guidelines for South Dakota (SD). Apply only within delegated underwriting and claims authority. These standards do not create coverage, replace policy wording, or establish government requirements.

Application and eligibility

Record named insureds, garaging address, vehicle identification, ownership, annual mileage, permitted drivers, vehicle use, prior coverage, and loss history. Refer delivery, rideshare, fleet, modified vehicles, and commercial use to the appropriate product specialist. Do not bind when material facts remain unresolved.

Coverage design

Compare bodily injury, property damage, collision, comprehensive, medical-related coverages, uninsured and underinsured motorist options, rental, and roadside assistance against the insured need. Record selected limits and deductibles. A checklist entry is not a coverage grant; the issued forms and endorsements control.

Risk selection and referral

Use authorized rating inputs only. Review driver and vehicle reports through approved access. Route eligibility exceptions, disputed report data, unusual use, and coverage gaps to an underwriter. Document reasons and prohibit unsupported proxy discrimination.

Claims handling

Capture loss date, location, parties, injuries, police-report availability, photographs, repair estimates, and coverage facts. Escalate injury, litigation, suspected fraud, and disputed coverage. Do not promise payment before coverage and authority are established.

State risk review

For South Dakota (SD), screen for address-level flood, severe weather, fire, theft, liability, and service interruption exposure; winter driving, freeze damage, snow loading, and seasonal access; hail, straight-line wind, tornado, and accumulated catastrophe concentration. These are internal screening priorities, not a finding that a particular location has the exposure. Validate the individual risk with current evidence.

Decision record and quality control

Record the SD jurisdiction, product, form version, evidence, coverage discussion, referral decision, approver, and communication history. Require a second review for authority exceptions. Keep internal business rules separate from legally required rules and retain the evidence under the approved retention schedule.

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